



A 10-MINUTE TEAM CHECK

DO WE ACTUALLY HAVE A STRATEGY?

Five questions to find out.

01

What is our winning aspiration?

Name the outcome you are trying to create. Not the project. Not the revenue target. The meaningful win that gives every other choice a direction.

QUICK CHECK

If the answer sounds like a KPI, keep going.

Where will we play?

Choose the customers, problems, channels and geographies that matter. A real choice should make it clear where you will not play.

THE TEST

Can the team name the places you have deliberately ruled out?

How will we win there?

Name the advantage that makes people choose you. “Better service” and “great people” are rarely distinctive enough on their own.

PRESS ON THE ANSWER

If a competitor could say the same thing, it is not an advantage yet.

What must we be unusually good at?

Identify the two or three abilities the organisation must perform consistently for the first three choices to be credible.

KEEP IT TIGHT

If everything is a capability, nothing is.

What systems make it real?

Measures, routines, incentives and decisions turn capability into behaviour. If the systems reward the opposite, the strategy loses.

CHECK THE SYSTEM

Does it reward the behaviour your strategy actually needs?

TEST

What would have to be true?

Every choice rests on assumptions. Put them on paper, rank them by risk, then test the weakest one first.

DO THIS NEXT

Write the five answers on one page.
Circle the assumption you trust least.
Test that before polishing the plan.